

OXFORD SAID

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT SAID

Oxford Saïd is the business school of the University of Oxford, one of the UK's oldest and most prestigious Universities. Leveraging its links to the wider University, Oxford Saïd offers two full-time MBA tracks: a one year MBA and a two year 1+1 MBA which in which participants combine a master's degree from one of the partnering departments at the University of Oxford with an MBA.

Oxford University operates a collegiate system, whereby each degree student is be attached to one of the University's 45 colleges. Oxford's colleges are independent, self-governing, and multidisciplinary, each comprising of students, faculty, and administration. A community within a community, the college system provides an opportunity for MBA students make friendships quickly with students from a range of disciplines while benefiting from dedicated facilities, sports, and social events.

The MBA cohort is comprised of just over 300 students, making it larger than its main rival, Cambridge Judge, but slightly smaller than the UK's leading MBA programme at London Business School. The school relaunched its MBA curriculum in 2016, which is now organised around three themes: responsible leadership, the global rules of the game, and entrepreneurship. These three themes permeate all aspects of the program, from core and elective courses to guest speaker sessions and student-run competitions. Students also benefit from a talent development programme that starts from the start of the programme and includes the opportunity to work with an executive coach.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS

Corporate Social Responsibility, Entrepreneurship, International Management, and Finance

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
BusinessWeek	4	51	12	12	*
Financial Times	33	27	13	21	17
Forbes	6	-	5	-	-
The Economist	75	78	62	-	*
US News	-	-	-	-	-

CLASS OF 2020 ADMISSIONS

MBA Class Size	311
Total Tuition	£63,000
Avg Age	30
Avg GMAT	680
% International	92%
% Women	47%

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2020)

Global Industry (tech, energy, healthcare)	40.5%
Financial Services	30.8%
Consulting	16.8%
Social Impact	11.9%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

BCG, Deloitte Consulting, EY, IDEO, McKinsey, Strategy&, Big Society Capital, CDC Group, JP Morgan, KPMG, Visa, Agoda, Amazon, Google, Microsoft, Veratrak

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: €73,433

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 95%

**Rankings are relative to other non-U.S. business schools. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.*



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR OXFORD SAID APPLICATION

BY CASSANDRA PITTMAN

Cassandra is a Columbia MBA alumna and former member of the admissions teams at both INSEAD and London Business School. A certified coach, she combines a career in admissions, consulting, and creative business with her knack for weaving a compelling narrative and her passion for helping leaders realise their potential to help Fortuna clients achieve their dreams.



**Showcase responsible leadership,
emphasis on *responsible*.**

1

SHOWCASE RESPONSIBLE LEADERSHIP, EMPHASIS ON RESPONSIBLE

Oxford Saïd says its purpose is to “prepare business leaders for the task of making the world a better and more equitable place.” A lot of schools want you to showcase your leadership, but for Saïd, it is critical that you are able to demonstrate how your leadership has led to making the world better. This can seem a tall and intimidating order if you’re not already at the helm of a global not-for-profit, but thinking just a few points down the value chain can help here. How is the business you’re in, ultimately, a force for good? How have you helped develop people and projects so that lives are affected in a positive way? How will your Oxford MBA enable you to make an event greater impact on issues that matter? Answering these questions before you sit down to write your essays will help set you up for success.

START YOUR POST-MBA CAREER SEARCH RIGHT NOW

2

One year does not leave a lot of time for career exploration, and the admission committee knows this. Saïd asks you to detail not just your precise career goal, but also what your sector looks for in MBA talent, how you meet those requirements and how the Oxford MBA will help you achieve your goals. In order to adequately answer those questions, you need to have done a significant amount of networking and research, so before applying make sure you have reached out to people in your target industry and location (and Oxford Saïd alumni if you can) to make sure you can demonstrate a depth of understanding about what it will take to achieve your goals.

3

APPLY EARLY

Most schools will tell you that your chances of getting in in later rounds is more or less equal to earlier rounds. Not so with Oxford Saïd. Saïd operates four admissions stages running from early September through early April. However, they are open in saying that they offer good candidates as they come in, rather than holding spaces for all rounds, and that they cannot guarantee places will be available in the later rounds of admission.

DO YOUR RESEARCH ON THE UNIVERSITY

4

One of the MBA programme's principle strengths is its integration with the wider University of Oxford. The admission committee appreciates candidates who can show that they know and appreciate the value that comes with Oxford University's world-class learning community. Think here about how you will engage in the college system and how you will benefit from thinking and innovations that are happening across the wider university.

5

FIND YOUR INNER ENTREPRENEUR

Entrepreneurship is one of three over-arching themes of the new MBA curriculum at Oxford, and the entrepreneurship module is one that cuts across the entire MBA curriculum. Not everyone has entrepreneurial ambitions *per se* but this module is about entrepreneurial thinking in its widest sense – innovations in businesses and within society as a whole. To demonstrate your fit with the school, it will be helpful to think about time you've innovated or approached a problem or project in a novel way. And also, how you will bring this thinking to your future career.

For more insider insights into Oxford Saïd, please visit the Fortuna [blog](#).

DATES & DEADLINES

	Application Deadline	Interview Decision Deadline	Final Decision Deadline
R1	1 Sept 2021	29 Sept 2021	27 Oct 2021
R2	13 Oct 2021	10 Nov 2021	8 Dec 2021
R3	12 Jan 2022	16 Feb 2022	16 March 2022
R4	23 March 2022	20 April 2022	25 May 2022



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, MIT Sloan, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, contact us at: FortunaAdmissions.com

